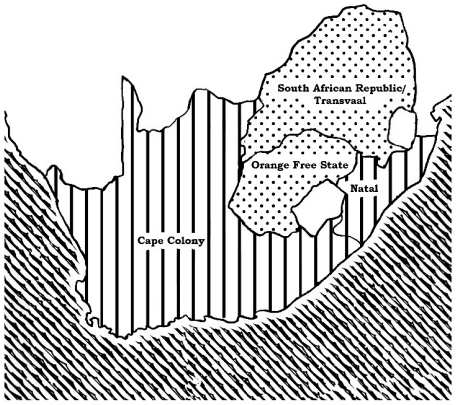
WHY DID SO MANY INDIANS LIVE IN SOUTH AFRICA?

WHEN GANDHI WAS A YOUNG MAN, THE BRITISH AND THE DUTCH GOVERNED DIFFERENT PARTS OF SOUTH AFRICA. CAPE COLONY AND NATAL WERE BRITISH COLONIES. DUTCH SETTLERS (THE BOERS) CONTROLLED THE TERRITORIES OF TRANSVAAL AND ORANGE FREE STATE. IN THE 1860S, MANY INDIANS CAME TO NATAL TO WORK ON THE SUGAR AND COFFEE PLANTATIONS. MORE INDIANS ARRIVED, WORKING AS MERCHANTS, AND INDIAN COMMUNITIES GREW. THE BRITISH SAW THEM AS A THREAT TO THEIR BUSINESSES. BY 1894 IN NATAL, INDIANS OUTNUMBERED WHITES 43,000 TO 40,000. SO TO CONTROL THE INDIAN POPULATION, THE BRITISH PASSED LAWS THAT LIMITED THEIR EQUALITY AND RIGHTS.

SOUTH AFRICA



BRITISH

BOER